

SASH MOHAPATRA

AI Education & Enablement Leader

20 years helping people and companies adapt to technological change

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SUMMARY

For 20 years I have helped people and companies navigate major technological change. I develop and deliver the strategy, content, curriculum, and hands-on learning that carry both business users and technical teams through each shift: the data center, the cloud, and enterprise AI. I have trained over 1,000 professionals and built international training programs at Microsoft. Today I build AI-native education with Claude: a live cohort certification, an original teaching method, and a production system that uses Claude to create the learning itself. I lead with taste and measure what works, so hard technical ideas become work people can actually do.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Enterprise Technology Enablement · Enterprise Technology Adoption · Skilling & Curriculum Design · Technical Instruction · AI-Assisted Content Production · Multi-Format Learning (hands-on labs, video, interactive) · Cross-Functional Leadership · Learning Measurement & Learning Science

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Rift Lab (AI Education & Advisory) · riftlab.ai

New York, NY | 2024-Present

Rift Lab scales human capability with AI systems. I build and teach the skilling curriculum that enables it. I advise leaders through AI adoption and change.

- Created and now teach a live cohort certification, the AI Orchestration Certification for Knowledge Workers. Launched November 2025 and trained more than 120 people across six public and private cohorts since, rated 4.9/5 on Maven.
- Authored The Orchestrator Method™, a five-principle system for delegating professional work to AI, and the AIM Framework™ for communicating with AI. Designed a tiered credential ladder (Foundations, Practitioner, Architect) that meets learners where they are and builds them from AI fluency to AI orchestration.
- Built an AI-native content production system on Claude, using Claude Code, custom skills, specialized subagents, and connected tools. It produces the curriculum and content itself, modeling how to use AI in content work with human oversight.
- Delivered private enablement cohorts on AI orchestration for non-technical teams at a global semiconductor leader, a workforce-strategy firm, and a consumer jewelry brand.
- Designed an enterprise AI-skilling framework that meets people where they are, then advances them from fluency to orchestration to stewardship, backed by change-management strategies for adoption.
- Advised C-level executives and analysts on AI adoption and change management, drawing on two decades leading enterprise technology transformation.

Microsoft | Account Director, Data & AI Sales, Capital Markets

New York, NY | 2020-2023

Led enterprise data and AI enablement for capital-markets institutions.

- Enabled asset managers, data providers, and financial firms to adopt Azure data and AI. Guided executive and technical stakeholders through transformation across a portfolio exceeding \$100M in revenue.
- Directed cross-specialty architect teams and coordinated every workstream on each account.
- Led the Microsoft-side data and AI strategy for MSCI's migration from its own data centers to Azure, generating \$40M in Azure revenue over three years. Built the CDO and data-team relationships and directed a virtual team of Microsoft specialists across data engineering, analytics, and machine learning.

- Led the data and AI strategy for Louis Dreyfus Company as it built cloud analytics at scale across its commodities trading lines, partnering with the CDO and data teams and connecting them to Microsoft product groups and executive briefings.
- Translated data and AI strategy into terms leaders could plan and act on. Delivered 115% of quota in FY22 and 100% year-over-year territory growth.

Microsoft | Principal Sales Architect, Modern Work

New York, NY | 2016-2020

Led enablement and technical strategy for cloud-productivity transformation at major financial institutions.

- Led enablement on a global, systemically important bank's \$200M+ move to the cloud: educated IT admins on migration and data privacy, executives on banking use cases, and legal on eDiscovery in the Microsoft suite, and cleared compliance with the bank's security org (Microsoft Gold Club, 2018).
- Built demos and learning modules that helped IT and business users adopt cloud productivity, translating banking workflows into use cases leaders could act on.
- Developed banking-specific enablement content for several global, systemically important banks.
- Trained and coached 30+ specialist sellers on banking use cases and how they map to the Microsoft productivity stack.
- Interviewed, hired, and mentored MBA talent through Microsoft's campus hiring program across more than a decade at the company.

Microsoft | Senior Client Success Manager, Office 365

New York, NY | 2014-2016

One of a handful of client success managers in a then-new role, enabling global financial-services clients through their first move to cloud productivity.

- Managed 33 strategic global financial-services accounts, helping teams adopt Office 365. Drove month-over-month active-usage growth through hands-on user education and adoption programs.
- Removed deployment blockers across strategic accounts, driving 60% year-over-year consumption growth.

Microsoft | Senior Field Engineer, Field Engineering

New York & India | 2006-2014

Developed and delivered technical curriculum to enterprise IT at global scale.

- Developed IP curriculum with global virtual teams and delivered it to enterprise IT professionals across Southeast Asia and the United States. Trained more than 1,000 practitioners over the decade.
- Built and taught hands-on technical training with self-authored labs on Exchange Server, ISA Server, Active Directory, and hybrid-cloud migration.
- Ran large-scale risk assessments across enterprise data centers of 400 to 500 servers, improving IT health and reducing support incidents.
- Earned Microsoft Top Talent (2014) and Leadership Impact (2015) awards for building and delivering international training programs.

Microsoft | Enterprise Support Engineer

Bengaluru, India | 2004-2006

- Resolved mission-critical (Sev-1) global outages for enterprise customers within SLA. Built a foundation in enterprise Exchange Server administration.

EDUCATION

B.E., Telecommunications Engineering, Visvesvaraya Technological University, Bengaluru

RECOGNITION

Microsoft Gold Club (2018) · Platinum Technical Contributor (2019) · Leadership Impact Award (2015) · Top Talent (2014)